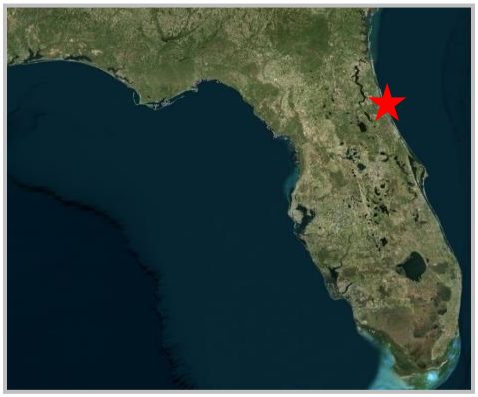
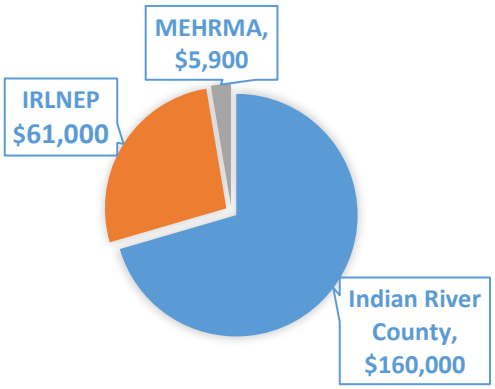
Jones Pier Living Shoreline, Indian River County, FL

FY 18/19



Project Partners and Funding



Project Description

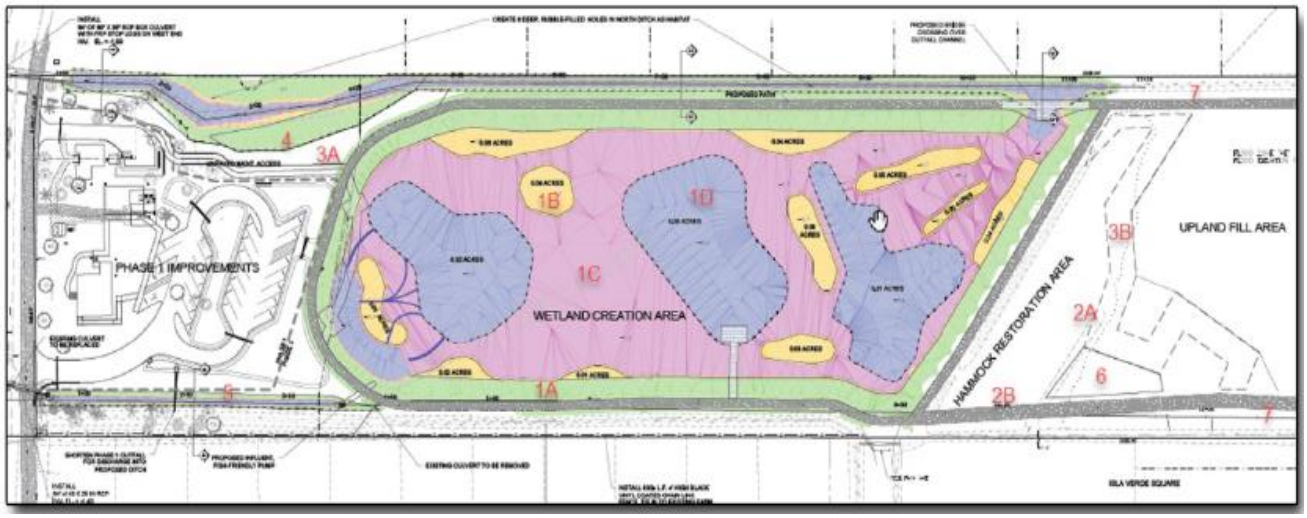


Figure 1 Conceptual plan for the Jones Pier created wetland and shoreline project.

The Jones Pier Conservation Area (JPCA) is part of the rich history of late 19th century/early 20th century settlement in Indian River County. In 1889, Seaborn Jones and his family homesteaded 160 acres on Orchid Island. Mr. Jones and his neighbors built the "Orchid-Narrows Road" which is now known as Jungle Trail (listed in 2003 on the National Register of Historic Places). The 16-acre JPCA that was purchased by the County in 2011 (including the docks) is part of this original homestead. The County acquired the site from the Jones' family with assistance from the Florida Communities Trust (FCT). As part of the purchase, the County committed to implementing a management plan for the site that restores ecological value, while at the same time utilizes the existing buildings on the property for public access and display of educational and historical exhibits. To this end, the County has developed a Master Plan for the site that includes restoration/creation of wetlands on-site as well as a Living Shoreline.

The improvements include the creation of a 2.8-acre high marsh community that will filter Lagoon waters (Fig. 1). High marsh is a rare resource in this portion of the Indian River Lagoon (IRL), and it is anticipated that this

wetland will provide diverse habitat and improved water quality in proximity to the site. The construction of the high marsh is to be funded, in part, through a grant from the Indian River Lagoon National Estuary Program (IRLNEP) with matching funds from the County. The discharge location for the high marsh wetland occurs within a section of shoreline where concrete and rubble were deposited historically to minimize erosion. There is minimal coverage by desirable shoreline vegetation, and very little potential habitat for wildlife. The entire 2.25-mile section of Jungle Trail that fronts the Lagoon is devoid of emergent herbaceous vegetation. MEHRMA funds provide for the construction of ~125 linear feet of functional living shoreline along Jungle trail, a highly visible section of the Indian River Lagoon. The living shoreline will function as the terminal section of the habitat and water quality improvement efforts on the JPCA. During FY 2018/19, MEHRMA funds were used to purchase the native coquina rock boulders which will be placed along the shoreline and coupled with native plants. The County also plans to incorporate extensive educational displays showcasing the importance of these types of habitats with respect to the ecology of the Lagoon environment.

Benefits

- Living shorelines provide a natural solution for erosion
- Living shorelines provide important habitat for fish and wildlife
- Plants used in the design will assist with nutrient uptake for the IRL

FWC Strategic Plan Elements Supported

Theme 1, Goal 2: Make sure there are sufficient quantities and quality of habitats to support healthy and diverse fish and wildlife populations.

Strategies:

- Secure and maintain sufficient interconnected quantities of habitats to sustain healthy fish and wildlife populations.

Acreage restored by habitat type (footprint)

This project entails the construction of a Living Shoreline along 125 linear feet (0.06acres) and is part of the restoration/creation of 2.8 acres of coastal wetlands:

- The living shoreline will provide erosion protection, nutrient uptake, and habitat for fish and wildlife

Acreage affected by restoration activities: 0.06acres of a 2.8-acre project



Figure 2: Aerial view of the Living Shoreline proposed for Jones Pier.